SOC Talent Bridge Initiative

Connecting University SOC Experience with Industry Engagement

Commonwealth University – Bloomsburg

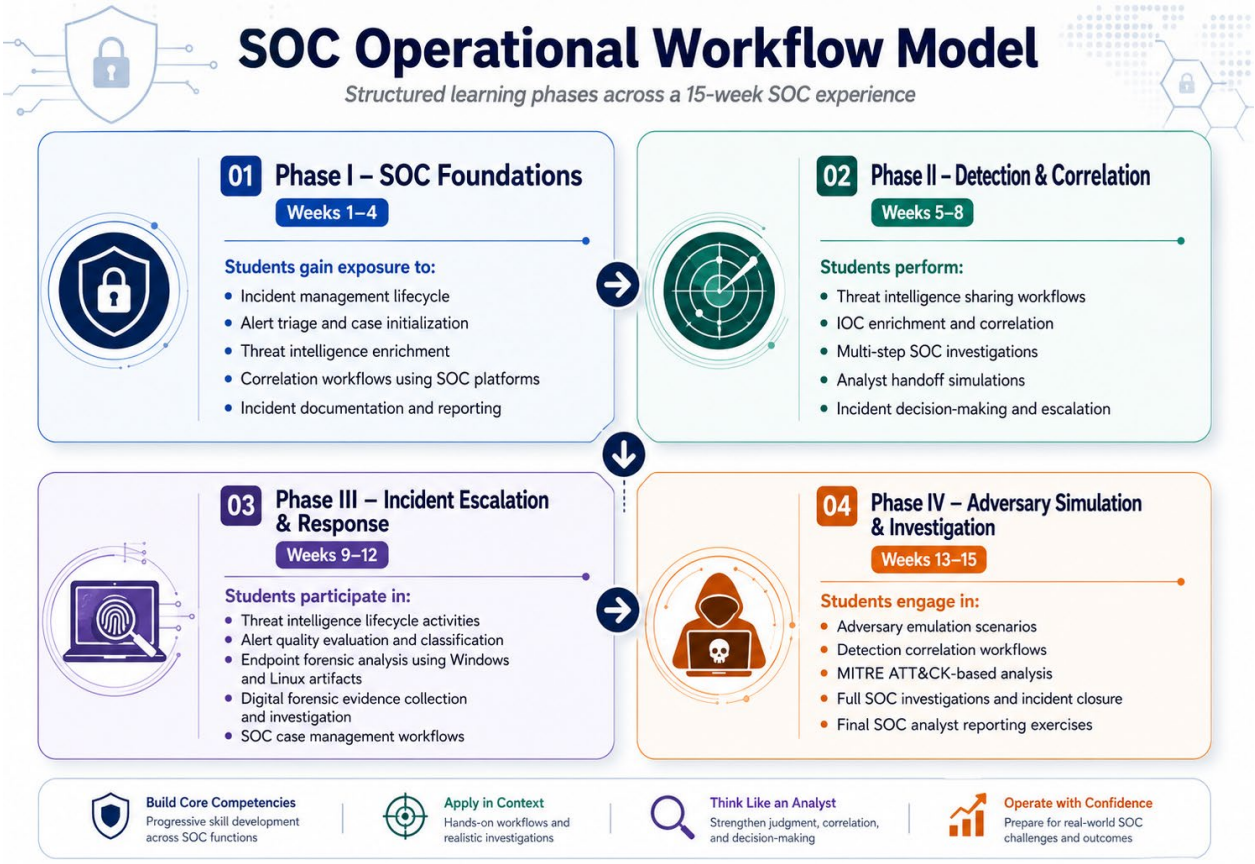
The SOC Talent Bridge Initiative is a structured cybersecurity workforce development effort within the Commonwealth University–Bloomsburg Center for Digital Forensics and Cybersecurity Studies. The initiative provides undergraduate students with hands-on experience in cybersecurity operations through an educational and simulated Security Operations Center (SOC) environment. Operating since Fall 2025 under the supervision of Professor Dr. Atdhe Buja, the SOC Lab exposes students to practical SOC workflows, incident response processes, threat investigation, threat intelligence enrichment, and digital forensics activities designed to simulate real-world cybersecurity operations environments.

University Article

Building the Cybersecurity Workforce: A SOC Lab Experience at CU–Bloomsburg

Student Experience & Program Structure

The initiative is conducted as a structured, independent study utilizing a semester-based SOC assignment and operational workflow model.



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Educational SOC Environment

The SOC environment incorporates operational workflows and technologies aligned with cybersecurity operations and incident response education, including:

- Incident management workflows
- Threat intelligence correlation
- SIEM/XDR exposure
- Endpoint visibility and forensic analysis
- Controlled attack simulation scenarios
- Team-based SOC collaboration and reporting

The initiative aligns with educational concepts associated with:

- NICE Workforce Framework for Cybersecurity
- NIST SP 800-61 Incident Handling Guidance

Potential Areas of Collaboration

The initiative seeks to strengthen collaboration between academia and the cybersecurity industry through:

- Guest speaker participation
- SOC Lab visits and demonstrations
- Student mentorship and career discussions
- Internship and workforce readiness engagement
- Industry insight into operational cybersecurity skills

Vision

The SOC Talent Bridge Initiative aims to strengthen the connection between university cybersecurity education and operational workforce preparation by helping students develop practical cybersecurity operations experience while fostering long-term engagement between academia and industry professionals.

The initiative seeks to strengthen collaboration between academia and industry while helping prepare students for operational cybersecurity roles through experiential learning and applied SOC workflows.

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